$$5(1-x) = -4x - 1$$

$$5 - 5x = -4x - 1$$
$$+5x \qquad +5x$$

$$5 = x - 1$$
$$+1 \qquad +1$$

$$6 = x$$

$$x = 6$$

$$17 = (x+1) + 2(x-4)$$

$$17 = 3x - 7$$
$$+7 \qquad\qquad +7$$

$$\frac{24}{3} = \frac{3x}{3}$$

$$8 = x$$

$$x = 8$$